

Predicting Wine Quality Using Machine Learning

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I. INTRODUCTION

The task of predicting wine quality is crucial for enhancing the consistency and marketability of wines. This work focuses on classifying wines into quality categories using a machine learning approach. The study utilizes Random Forest and SVM classifiers, addressing challenges such as data imbalance and evaluation of minority classes. The contributions of this work are as follows:

1. Exploration of preprocessing and oversampling techniques for imbalanced data.
2. Evaluation of machine learning algorithms based on F1 Score, emphasizing the need for balanced performance.
3. Insights into optimizing predictive models for the wine industry.

II. DATASET AND PREPROCESSING

A. Dataset Overview

The dataset, obtained from the UC Irvine Machine Learning Repository, comprises 1,599 rows and 12 features representing chemical properties of wines. These features include acidity, alcohol content, and pH. The target variable indicates wine quality as either "Good" or "Bad."

B. Challenges in Data

The dataset exhibits a significant class imbalance, with "Bad" wines being the majority class and "Good" wines underrepresented.

C. Preprocessing Steps

Data Cleaning: No missing values were identified in the dataset. Feature Scaling: Standardization was applied to ensure all features contributed proportionally to the model

III. METHODOLOGY

This study addresses the challenge of predicting wine quality, a critical task in the wine industry for ensuring product excellence and consumer trust. Using a publicly available dataset from the UC Irvine Machine Learning Repository, we preprocess and analyze the data to develop predictive models. Employing Random Forest and Support Vector Machine (SVM)

classifiers, along with oversampling techniques like SMOTE to handle class imbalance, the study demonstrates the efficacy of F1 Score as an evaluation metric for robust model assessment. Results highlight the importance of balancing datasets in improving classification fairness and overall model performance.

A. Algorithms

Random Forest: Known for its robustness and interpretability, Random Forest leverages ensemble learning by aggregating multiple decision trees to minimize overfitting.

Support Vector Machine (SVM): Effective in high-dimensional spaces, SVM optimizes a hyperplane for class separation.

B. Evaluation Metric

Given the imbalanced nature of the dataset, F1 Score was chosen as the primary evaluation metric. F1 Score is the harmonic mean of precision and recall, offering a balanced measure that accounts for false positives and false negatives.

C. Data Splitting and Cross-Validation

The dataset was split into training (80%) and testing (20%) subsets. Repeated K-Fold Cross-Validation ensured robust performance evaluation across multiple data partitions.

IV. RESULTS

A. Initial Model Performance

Before addressing class imbalance, the Random Forest classifier achieved an accuracy of 80.31%. The F1 Scores for the majority ("Bad") and minority ("Good") classes were 0.793 and 0.812, respectively.

B. Post-Balancing Performance

After applying SMOTE, the class distribution was balanced, improving recall for the minority class. The Random Forest classifier maintained stable accuracy (80.00%) with the following metrics:

- **Precision:** 0.767 (Class 0), 0.832 (Class 1)
- **Recall:** 0.819 (Class 0), 0.784 (Class 1)
- **F1 Score:** 0.792 (Class 0), 0.807 (Class 1)

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C. DISCUSSION

A. Impact of SMOTE

Balancing the dataset using SMOTE significantly improved recall for the minority class while maintaining overall accuracy. The reduction in false negatives for "Bad" quality wines indicates improved fairness and reliability of predictions. Figures and Tables

B. Limitations and Future Work

Despite the improvements, the slight trade-off in precision for "Good" quality wines highlights the need for further optimization. Future work could explore:

1. Advanced feature engineering techniques.
2. Hyperparameter tuning for both Random Forest and SVM models.
3. Integration of ensemble methods for enhanced performance.

CONCLUSION

This study demonstrates that addressing class imbalance is essential for fair and reliable wine quality classification. Using Random Forest and SVM models alongside SMOTE, we achieved balanced performance metrics, emphasizing the importance of F1 Score for evaluating imbalanced datasets. These findings can guide future efforts in predictive modeling for the wine industry.

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